

Chapter 28-1

After entering the drama crew, Yin Lingzhu had to admire that Yan Si had really invested heavily.

The director was famously upright and would never let people bring investment money into the crew. Important roles were all personally auditioned by him.

Previously, someone had tried to stuff money into the crew and demanded the lead role right away. The director didn't indulge that person and, in front of everyone, mercilessly shouted them away without saving any face.

Furthermore, he posted on Weibo¹ to condemn this behavior. What was even more ruthless was that he also published that person's name.

This meant that actor's future was completely ruined—any director who cared about their reputation wouldn't use her anymore.

For Yan Si to get her directly into the crew showed how much effort she had put in.

Yin Lingzhu smiled and greeted the crew members. The director looked at her and smiled, beckoning her over with his hand.

The assistant director saw the director's demeanor and his eyes widened.

The director was actually being so kind to this newcomer. He had been by the director's side for so many years, and the people who could make the director smile could be counted on one hand.

"Little Yin, don't feel pressured. I also know this is your first time acting." The director looked at the well-behaved Yin Lingzhu in front of him.

"You've also read the script. Although it's the second female lead, you don't need to be too nervous. This character is very easy to portray."

The director spoke gently as if afraid of scaring Yin Lingzhu, describing how relaxed it would be to portray this character.

"Moreover, our post-production staff are technically excellent."

Yin Lingzhu kept smiling and nodding. She understood what the director meant.

No matter how she performed this role, the director's post-production would edit it to be outstanding.

Yin Lingzhu kept nodding until she saw the director had nothing more to say, then thought of his reputation in the industry.

Talking this much with her today was probably already his limit.

After Yin Lingzhu left, the assistant director dared to ask, "Director, who is she that you treat her so well?"

He had been by the director's side for so long and had never seen the director like this.

"You don't understand. We can film this drama entirely because of her." The director looked at the assistant director and sighed.

The assistant director caught the meaning in his words, "You said before that filming this drama would require a lot of funding."

"Yes, two investors, both because of her." The director looked at Yin Lingzhu as if looking at a lifeline.

"Two?" The assistant director said in shock.

The director glared at him, "So many questions. Go quickly and set up the scene."

The director hurriedly dismissed the assistant director.

In the time the director was speaking, Yin Lingzhu had already greeted all the crew members and at least gained some familiarity.

Holding the clothes in her hands, Yin Lingzhu knocked on the door half apprehensively, half helplessly.

Earlier, someone had suddenly given her a period costume and told her to deliver it to Yan Si's dressing room.

Yin Lingzhu had wanted to refuse, but the person who gave her the clothes seemed very urgent, and she couldn't bring herself to say she didn't want to go.

She knocked for a long time with no response. She breathed a sigh of relief—fortunately no one was there, otherwise she wouldn't know how to face Yan Si.

When she opened the door, seeing the person sitting in front of the makeup mirror, Yin Lingzhu paused but immediately adjusted her expression.

"Hello, President Yan." Yin Lingzhu smiled and spoke politely.

While chatting with the crew members earlier, she had learned that Yan Si was playing the female lead.

Not only that, but the female lead and female second lead also had some romantic entanglement.

Yan Si looked at her, "Why must you be like this?"

Yin Lingzhu maintained her polite smile, "Like what?"

"President Yan doesn't like me smiling? That's right, President Yan never smiled in front of me before." Yin Lingzhu said sarcastically.

Hearing her use words to needle her, Yan Si said, "That's not what I meant."

"You don't need to smile like this." Yan Si looked at her, lowering her eyes, which were filled with sorrow.

Having seen a genuine smile, she could distinguish the fake at a glance.

She had seen Yin Lingzhu smile happily because of her, so she could also see how formulaic Yin Lingzhu's current smile was.

Thinking this, tears welled up in Yan Si's eyes.

But when she raised her eyes, Yin Lingzhu had already left.

Her expression was only seen by one person hiding in the shadows, watching through the window.

Yin Lingzhu left the moment Yan Si lowered her head.

She couldn't distinguish Yan Si's sincerity—her acting skills were truly too superb.

Lost in thought, Yin Lingzhu accidentally bumped into someone.

"I'm sorry, I'm sorry." Yin Lingzhu bent down repeatedly to apologize.

Her gaze fell on the area where they had collided. The neatly pressed suit now had wrinkles.

Very conspicuous.

Yin Lingzhu silently calculated in her mind how much she would have to pay to compensate for this suit.

"It's fine, it's not your fault, it's mine." Ming Qingyun smiled as she spoke.

Her suit was straight and sharp, but the unconcealed smile on her face softened the serious atmosphere.

Yin Lingzhu looked at the person in front of her who was smiling happily, somewhat confused.

Someone bumps into you and you can still be this happy?

"Haven't we met somewhere before?" Yin Lingzhu asked with some confusion, carefully studying the face of the person opposite her.

Ming Qingyun looked at her, the curve of her mouth unchanged, "We went to the same university."

After speaking, she carefully watched Yin Lingzhu's reaction.

Trying to find something.

"Um, I'm sorry, I probably can't remember." Yin Lingzhu looked at her with slight embarrassment.

The other person could remember who she was, but she couldn't remember who they were.

This situation would be awkward for anyone.

"It's okay, let's exchange contact information." Ming Qingyun took out her phone.

Yin Lingzhu naturally took out her phone. Looking at Ming Qingyun's WeChat² profile picture, she felt that even the profile picture looked very familiar.

"We really have met somewhere before." Yin Lingzhu's voice was full of confusion, but no matter how hard she tried, she couldn't remember who this person was.

Ming Qingyun looked at her with some disappointment, but quickly concealed it.

Her tone was indifferent, as if she didn't care at all, "Maybe it's because I was the freshman representative that year."

Hearing Ming Qingyun say this, Yin Lingzhu felt something was wrong but didn't think about it further.

Maybe she had remembered incorrectly.

She was about to say a few more words, but Yin Lingzhu saw the assistant director waving at her.

"Someone's calling me, I'll go first." Yin Lingzhu looked toward the assistant director.

"Mm, let's chat more when we have the chance." Ming Qingyun followed her gaze and also noticed the assistant director.

Footnotes:

¹ Weibo (微博): China's largest social media platform, similar to Twitter

² WeChat (微信): China's most popular messaging app and social media platform